

10 iPhone and iPad OS

No detailed mention of Mac OS X can be complete without referring to its most famous derivative the iPhone OS which is found on the iPhone, iTouch and now the iPad. iPhone OS is based upon the “Darwin” foundation much like the Mac OS X with a heavily modified user interface to support multi-touch gestures. The current version of iPhone OS for iPhone and iTouch is 3.1 [recently updated to 3.1.3] and for the just announced iPad, there is version 3.2 available of iPhone OS. The iPhone OS 3.2 is incompatible with iPhone or iTouch devices and can be run only on the iPad.

10.1 iPhone OS 3.1

This modification of the famous OS is backward compatible in terms of app support, which effectively means you can straight run apps written

for the iPhone/iTouch without any modifications. Further the apps can be run either in the original resolution or they can be maximized to utilize the mammoth screen estate available.

This revision of the OS is pretty similar in functionality (or lack of it) as compared to the iPhone/iTouch version with one major exception. The iPad comes bundled with a brand new app from Apple itself called the “iBook”. The iBook is an ebook reader and an ebook store rolled into one with a magnificent UI, a near universal feature of all Apple products. To emphasise on the glorious UI, the books that you purchase via the online



Touch has emerged as the fastest growing interface

store are displayed in a virtual wooden book shelf with their front covers and single tap is sufficient to open and display them with flip page animations. A pleasant surprise is found in the fact that the open-source ePub format is